

REVOLUTIONARIES

TEXT: Acts 19:23-27 *“About that time there arose a great disturbance about the Way. A silversmith named Demetrius, who made silver shrines of Artemis, brought in a lot of business for the craftsmen there. He called them together, along with the workers in related trades, and said: “you know, my friends, that we receive a good income from this business, and you see how this fellow Paul has convinced and led astray large numbers of people here in Ephesus and in practically the whole province of Asia. He says that gods made by human hands are no gods at all. There is danger not only that our trade will lose its good name, but also that the temple of the great goddess Artemis will be discredited. Soon the whole city was in an uproar. The assembly was in confusion.”*

INTRO: I have literally been in and around the church my whole life (Explain this).

I had the privilege of spending my teenage years in a church that was in the midst of a red hot, Holy Ghost revival. This experience impacted my life in a positive direction, and gave me an ongoing insatiable desire to see a real move of God in the earth, otherwise known in church circles as revival.

I have had the opportunity of being a part of some of the great revivals of the past (Brownsville – Malvern). I could literally morph into a revival junkie with little to no effort whatsoever. The revivals of the past have been more or less soaking events. They featured:

- Protracted services... (Weeks or even months in duration)
- Passionate worship...
- Sermons filled with conviction...
- Strong altar calls...
- Extended altar services...

There is certainly nothing wrong with any of this, in fact, I could live like this indefinitely.

One of the things I remember growing up is the prediction, if not prophecy, that there would be an end time revival. Based on this, we (The church) have waited with baited breath, for this tsunami of the presence of God to hit the church, so we can all sit in circles, hold hands, and soak in the presence of the Lord. But is this really what the reality of an end time revival will look like? I don't think so.

The Biblical prediction is that there will be an end time revival and a great falling away simultaneously. How can such a thing be? Here is what I am seeing happen:

- The love of many has waxed cold... (We are seeing this now – People can go everywhere but to church - Covid)
- Those who seek another soaking event have become discontented with organized religion, because they are not experiencing what they have witnessed in the past... (Many of these people have intentionally absented themselves not only from church services, but from the body of Christ altogether)
- The expectation of my generation has not been fulfilled... I think this is because we are looking for something that God never intended to send. (What if what the Lord is intending to send - and what we are expecting is two different things?)
- When our expectation and what the Lord is trying to do is different, is it possible for those who are hungry for the next great revival to miss it altogether? (I believe the answer to this is YES!)

I believe what God is going to do in this next season is going to be marked by the following characteristics:

- There will be tremendous numbers of people return to the God of their fathers and mothers... (Backsliders will return in mass numbers)
- Scores of people will be swept into the Kingdom of God...

- Scores of religious people will miss it altogether because it doesn't look like what they were expecting...
- This move of God will be ushered in on the shoulders of a revolution involving the five-fold gifts of Ephesians four... (Apostles – Prophets – Evangelists – Pastors – Teachers)
- The five-fold will be understood by these revolutionaries as intended for the organized church, but more importantly for the secular world... (Use the Gringos story as an example)
- Because many denominations have placed so much effort into discrediting the need for the five-fold, they will be relegated to watching this great shift happen from the sidelines...
- The manifestation of the sons and daughters of God as described in Romans eight will occur before our very eyes...
- The Ecclesia will begin to step up to the plate, and take its proper place on the leading edge of a cultural shift... (Believers will begin to take their rightful place in the seven spheres of cultural influence – Family - Religion – Business – Education – Arts and entertainment – Government – Media)

In our text the Apostle Paul was engaged in a spiritual revolution and was on the leading edge of a group of

revolutionaries, who would later be known as having
“Turned the world upside down.”

REVOLUTIONARIES AFFECT THE ECONOMY

A businessman from Ephesus, by the name of Demetrius, had created an economic boom by building God's of silver and gold and selling them throughout Asia.

The message Paul preached did not allow for such idols. Paul's preaching had such an impact that it got the attention of Demetrius, and he warned the Ephesians that if Paul were allowed to continue what he was doing, it would impact the economy of Ephesus. Think about that!

The gospel message affecting the economy! Business was down at the pagan temples because of the message Paul preached and the transforming work of Jesus Christ.

The preaching and teaching of revolutionaries should always have an effect on the economy, and I believe this coming revolution will do just that! I believe:

- The church will develop entrepreneurs...
- The church will launch people who have witty inventions...
- The church will produce a workforce that can be trusted...

- The church will move the needle of gross national product...

I am convinced that this is one of the ways the end time move of God will change society. The gospel will affect the trades of our cities.

REVOLUTIONARIES FOCUS ON WHAT THEY ARE FOR, RATHER THAN WHAT THEY ARE AGAINST

At Ephesus, Paul was on a Pro –Jesus campaign, more than an anti-everything else campaign. (The church has become known for its name calling and hateful rhetoric on cultural issues)

Sadly, the great moves of the past have become known more for what they were against, rather than what they were for! (We don't smoke, we don't chew, and we don't run with those who do)

I grew up in a church culture that was marked more by the do not's, rather than what we were being empowered to do. When I was growing up God didn't have much of a sense of humor, and wasn't much fun! (Explain this)

The truth of the matter is that those saints had the power of God on them, but sadly it didn't do much to change the world they lived in! (Most of their children do not even

serve Jesus today) This is not because what they had was not real, it is because the leaders of that day never taught them to take what they were experiencing at church, and deploy it in the seven spheres of influence in culture!

What they had was real! I experienced it for myself and it has an effect on me to this day! If they had understood why they were having the experience – To take it into the world to be salt and light – We would be living in a completely different world today!

I believe this next move of God will be marked by what we are for, not what we are against! Those who understand and embrace this next move of God:

- Will take their rightful place in culture...
- Will raise Godly families in an ungodly world...
- Will run for political office, and then serve with integrity...
- Will climb to the highest places of influence in the educational systems of our world... (Become classroom teachers - Serve on school boards – Become school administrators – Write curriculum – etc...)
- Will infiltrate social media platforms, and launch rival platforms...
- Write movies scripts – Become producers – Become actors – etc...

- Will lead churches and religious organizations that actually do what the church was designed to do, rather than create a bloated religious bureaucracy that supports a few fat cats at the top of the food chain...
- Will invent things – Launch business led by Godly principles – Become the next generation of billionaires... (If God is going to *“Take the wealth of the wicked and give it to the righteous”* He needs some righteous people who can properly manage it once they have it!)

REVOLUTIONARIES DIMINISH THE NEED FOR IMMORAL PRACTICES IN A SOCIETY

When God moves among his people it affects the livelihood and trade of any vice or immorality within that city or society. (This has happened with CT Church – Community Transformation)

A revolution was happening in Ephesus. Revolution is a strong word that means *“To turn upside down.”* Acts 17:6 makes that very statement about Paul and his team.

“These men who have turned the world upside down have come here also.” They were shaking things up in every city they went to, and they didn't do it with protest marches or boycotts; they did it through the faithful proclamation of the Gospel (The good news of Jesus)!

The gospel is the power of God. It does not merely release God's power – it is the power of God! When we speak the Gospel, power comes out of our mouths. When the good news of what God in Christ has done, comes out of our mouth, it is like beams of light driving away darkness:

- Revolutionaries find a way to empower believers!
- Revolutionaries light up the world with their example! (When we light up the world, we automatically dispel darkness)
- Revolutionaries change every environment they enter! (Joseph – His father's house – Potiphar's house – The prison – The palace)
- Revolutionaries raise the level of everyone they touch! (When a revolutionary walk into a relationship, everything changes – A changing tide raises and lowers the level of all boats, from a \$1,000 flat bottom boat to a \$10M yacht – Everything changes)

CONCLUSION:

Trust me, this next move of God is not going to be a soaking event for the church, it is going to light up the world. The world is ready for a gospel revolution, and I am determined that we will be the revolutionaries!

Millions, even billions of people in this world are tired of their old worn-out lives, full of failures and regrets. They

are sick and tired of being sick and tired! We have the answer and by the help and grace of God we are going to be the revolutionaries that introduce them to their answer! Jesus!

What an opportunity to offer people a new way of life! This is an opportunity for the world to exchange their old for His new.

David Garrison in his book “*A Wind In The House of Islam*” writes, the turning of Islamic people to Christ could be attributed to “*the fullness of time.*” (According to Wikipedia between 8.4 million and 10.2 million Muslims are converting to Christianity per year – 6 million from the continent of Africa alone) I call this a move of God! This is revolutionary! This is better than a soaking!

In this coming revolution, we the revolutionaries are going to open our mouths and let the Gospel be what it is – A brilliant, life-changing, culture shifting, family line changing, governmental cleansing, economically rewarding, difference maker.

Are we supposed to start the next revolution in our sphere of influence? Yes – A thousand times YES!!! It is time for us to let the revolution of the gospel that is already in us begin – the world is waiting!

I believe this next move of God will be predicated on Acts 17:6 and our generations will be known as “*The people who turned the world upside down.*”

What if we CAN do it?

What if we DECIDE to do it?

What if we DO it?